

USER GUIDE

TEAMCENTER DOCUMENT ACCESS AND REVISION WORKFLOW

User Guide for Technical and Manufacturing Documentation Users

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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IMPORTANT NOTICE

This User Guide is an independently created technical writing demonstration for a professional portfolio.

The screens, workflows, names, document numbers and examples used in this guide are fictional or generic representations created for demonstration purposes.

The guide is not an official Siemens Teamcenter user manual and should not be used as operational instructions for a live Teamcenter environment.

Actual Teamcenter workflows, permissions, interfaces and terminology may vary according to organisation configuration and software version.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Teamcenter is a product lifecycle management environment used by organisations to manage product-related information, engineering data, documents, revisions and lifecycle processes.

In a structured technical documentation environment, users may need to locate controlled documents, verify the current revision, review document status and access approved information.

This User Guide provides a simple reference for common document-related activities.

2. PURPOSE

The purpose of this guide is to help users understand a typical controlled-document workflow in Teamcenter.

The guide focuses on practical activities such as:

- Finding a document
- Reviewing document information
- Checking revisions
- Identifying the current version
- Understanding document status
- Accessing approved documentation
- Supporting documentation updates

The objective is to help users access the correct information while reducing the risk of using obsolete or uncontrolled documentation.

3. INTENDED AUDIENCE

This guide is intended for:

- Engineering users
- Manufacturing users

- Quality personnel
- Technical writers
- Documentation specialists
- Project teams
- Other authorised users who need access to controlled product documentation

Users should have appropriate access permissions and basic familiarity with their organisation's Teamcenter environment.

4. PREREQUISITES

Before using this guide, ensure that:

1. You have an authorised Teamcenter account.
2. Your account has the required permissions.
3. Teamcenter is available through your organisation's approved access method.
4. You know the document number, product number or search information.
5. You understand your organisation's document-control requirements.

If access is unavailable, contact the appropriate system administrator or support team.

5. KEY CONCEPTS

Understanding a few basic concepts makes document searching easier.

5.1 Document

A controlled technical file or information object maintained within the PLM environment.

Examples may include:

- Product specifications
- Engineering documents
- Technical manuals
- Work instructions
- Drawings
- Supporting technical documentation

5.2 Revision

A controlled version of a document representing an approved change or update.

Example:

Revision A → Revision B → Revision C

Each revision may represent a change to technical information, requirements or approved content.

5.3 Lifecycle Status

A document may move through defined lifecycle states.

Typical examples include:

Draft → Review → Approved → Released → Obsolete

The exact lifecycle states depend on organisational configuration.

5.4 Dataset / File Content

A document record may contain associated files or datasets representing the actual document content.

The terminology and structure may vary depending on the Teamcenter configuration.

6. ACCESSING TEAMCENTER

Step 1 — Open the Approved Teamcenter Environment

Use the access method provided by your organisation.

Do not use unofficial links or unapproved software to access controlled product information.

Step 2 — Sign In

Enter your authorised credentials.

Follow your organisation's authentication requirements.

If multi-factor authentication is enabled, complete the required verification.

Step 3 — Confirm Successful Access

After signing in, confirm that the Teamcenter environment loads correctly.

Depending on the configuration, you may see:

- Search
- Navigation
- Workspace
- Product information
- Recent items
- Folders
- Document or dataset information

The exact interface may differ between Teamcenter implementations.

7. FINDING A DOCUMENT

There are several ways to locate documentation.

A common approach is to search using:

- Document number
- Part number
- Product number
- Document title
- Revision

- Keyword

Example

Suppose you need to find the WC-100 Technical Manual.

Search for:

TM-WC-100-001

If the document number is known, it is generally preferable to search using the unique identifier rather than a broad keyword.

8. SEARCH EXAMPLE

User Requirement

"I need the current technical manual for WC-100."

Recommended Search

Search:

TM-WC-100-001

Review the Results

Check:

- Document title
- Document number
- Revision
- Lifecycle status
- Associated product
- Other identifying information

Do not open or use a document solely because the title appears correct.

Verify the revision and status before using it.

9. REVIEWING DOCUMENT INFORMATION

After locating the required document, review the available metadata.

Example:

Field	Example
Document Number	TM-WC-100-001
Title	WC-100 Technical Manual
Revision	B
Lifecycle Status	Released
Product	WC-100
Document Type	Technical Manual
Owner	Technical Documentation
Last Updated	25-Aug-2026

The values above are fictional examples.

10. CHECKING DOCUMENT REVISION

Revision control is critical when working with technical documentation.

Before using a document, confirm:

1. Document number is correct.
2. Product association is correct.
3. Revision is current.
4. Lifecycle status permits use.
5. Document content matches the required application.

Example

You find:

TM-WC-100-001 — Revision A

and

TM-WC-100-001 — Revision B

If Revision B is the current released revision, Revision A should not be used as the current technical reference.

11. OPENING A DOCUMENT

After confirming the document identity and status:

1. Select the required document.
2. Review the document information.
3. Select the available file or dataset.
4. Open the document using the approved viewing method.
5. Confirm the document content and revision.

If the document cannot be opened, do not assume that the document itself is incorrect.

The issue may be related to:

- Access permissions
 - File association
 - Application availability
 - Network connectivity
 - System configuration
-

12. DOWNLOADING OR VIEWING A DOCUMENT

Depending on organisational permissions, users may be able to view or download controlled documentation.

Before downloading:

- Confirm that downloading is permitted.

- Verify that the document is the required revision.
- Store downloaded copies only in approved locations.
- Do not distribute controlled documentation through unauthorised channels.

Downloaded copies may become outdated after a new revision is released.

For this reason, users should refer to the controlled source whenever possible.

13. IDENTIFYING THE CURRENT REVISION

When multiple revisions exist, determine which revision is current.

Example

Revision	Status	Use
A	Obsolete	Do not use as current reference
B	Superseded	Do not use as current reference
C	Released	Current approved revision

The status and lifecycle rules configured by the organisation determine whether a revision is available for operational use.

14. DOCUMENT STATUS

Users should understand the significance of document lifecycle status.

Draft

Document is being developed and may not be approved for operational use.

Review

Document is undergoing technical or stakeholder review.

Approved

Document has received required approval.

Released

Document is formally available for its intended use.

Obsolete

Document is no longer the current approved version.

The exact terminology may vary by organisation.

15. DOCUMENT LIFECYCLE EXAMPLE

A typical controlled-document workflow may look like:

Draft



Technical Review



SME Review



Approval



Released



Revision Required



New Revision



Review



Release



Previous Revision Superseded

This lifecycle helps maintain traceability and control over technical information.

16. SUBMITTING A DOCUMENTATION UPDATE

Where the user's role includes documentation updates, the process may involve:

1. Identify the required change.
2. Review the reason for the change.
3. Confirm the affected document.
4. Review the current revision.
5. Update the appropriate source content.
6. Record the change.
7. Submit the updated document for review.
8. Coordinate SME validation.
9. Address review comments.
10. Obtain required approval.
11. Release the updated revision.
12. Ensure the previous revision is appropriately superseded.

The exact workflow depends on organisational configuration.

17. REVISION REVIEW WORKFLOW

When updating a technical document, the documentation owner should ensure that the change is properly reviewed.

Example

Change Request

Update WC-100 installation clearance information.

↓

Impact Assessment

Identify affected documents.

↓

Content Update

Update the technical manual.

↓

Technical Review

Engineering validates the technical content.

↓

Documentation Review

Technical writer verifies structure, consistency and clarity.

↓

Approval

Authorised stakeholder approves the revision.

↓

Release

New revision becomes available.



Supersession

Previous revision is appropriately controlled.

18. SEARCH TIPS

Use specific search information whenever possible.

Good Search

TM-WC-100-001

Better Than

technical manual

The unique document number reduces the number of irrelevant search results.

Other useful search fields may include:

- Product number
 - Part number
 - Document type
 - Owner
 - Revision
 - Lifecycle status
-

19. COMMON USER ERRORS

Error 1 — Using an Old Download

Problem

A user continues using a locally saved document after a newer revision has been released.

Recommended Action

Return to the controlled repository and verify the current revision.

Error 2 — Searching Only by Title

Problem

Multiple documents may have similar titles.

Recommended Action

Use the document number or another unique identifier.

Error 3 — Ignoring Lifecycle Status

Problem

A document may exist in the system but not be approved for operational use.

Recommended Action

Always verify lifecycle status.

Error 4 — Sharing Uncontrolled Copies

Problem

A downloaded document may become outdated.

Recommended Action

Use approved repositories and distribution methods.

Error 5 — Updating the Wrong Revision

Problem

Content may be changed against an outdated or superseded revision.

Recommended Action

Confirm the current revision before beginning an update.

20. TROUBLESHOOTING

Problem	Possible Cause	Recommended Action
Cannot sign in	Account or authentication issue	Contact system support
Document not found	Incorrect search criteria	Search using document number or product number
Document cannot be opened	Permission or file association issue	Verify access and contact support
Multiple revisions appear	Historical revisions retained	Verify lifecycle status and current revision
Download unavailable	Permission restriction	Contact document owner/system administrator
Document appears outdated	Local copy or obsolete revision	Return to controlled repository
Search returns too many results	Search too broad	Use unique document number

21. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Q1. Why should I check the revision before using a document?

Because technical information may change. Using an obsolete revision can result in incorrect information being used during engineering, manufacturing, inspection or maintenance activities.

Q2. Can I keep a downloaded copy?

Only where organisational procedures permit it.

Controlled documents should generally be accessed through the approved system of record.

Q3. What should I do if I find incorrect technical information?

Do not silently modify the controlled document.

Raise the issue through the approved documentation, engineering or change-management process.

Q4. Who should validate technical content?

The appropriate Subject Matter Expert or technical authority should validate technical accuracy.

The technical writer is responsible for communicating the approved information clearly and consistently.

Q5. What should I do if two documents contain conflicting information?

Do not make assumptions.

Identify the documents and revisions involved and escalate the conflict to the appropriate technical or document owner.

22. QUICK REFERENCE

Finding a Controlled Document

Search → Identify → Verify → Open → Confirm Revision → Use

Updating a Document

Change Request → Impact Assessment → Update → SME Review → Documentation Review → Approval → Release

Before Using Technical Documentation

Ask:

- ☐ Is this the correct document?
 - ☐ Is the document number correct?
 - ☐ Is the product or part correct?
 - ☐ Is the revision current?
 - ☐ Is the lifecycle status appropriate?
 - ☐ Am I accessing it from an approved source?
-

23. DOCUMENT MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

Technical documentation should be maintained within the organisation's approved document and product lifecycle management environment.

Depending on organisational requirements, related documentation may be managed through systems such as:

- Teamcenter
- Windchill
- SharePoint
- Other approved document-management systems

The system of record should be clearly identified so users know where the authoritative version of a document is maintained.

24. DOCUMENTATION BEST PRACTICES

When creating or maintaining user-facing technical documentation:

Use Clear Language

Prefer short, direct instructions.

Use Consistent Terminology

Use the same product and system terminology throughout the document.

Organize Information Logically

Place frequently performed tasks where users can find them quickly.

Separate User Actions From Explanations

Make procedures easy to scan.

Include Expected Results

Help users determine whether the task was completed successfully.

Anticipate Common Errors

Provide troubleshooting guidance for likely user problems.

Control Revisions

Ensure users can identify the current approved information.

25. DOCUMENT LIFECYCLE AND CHANGE CONTROL

This User Guide is maintained as a controlled documentation asset.

Changes may be required when:

- Teamcenter functionality changes.
- Organisational workflows change.
- User permissions change.
- Document-management processes change.
- New documentation requirements are introduced.
- User feedback identifies usability issues.

Each significant change should be reviewed for technical accuracy and user impact before release.

26. RELATED DOCUMENTATION

The following fictional documents form part of the wider documentation portfolio:

SPEC-WC-100

WC-100 Product Specification

WI-WC-100-001

WC-100 Manufacturing Work Instruction

SOP-WC-100-001

WC-100 Product Quality Review and Release SOP

TM-WC-100-001

WC-100 Technical Manual

27. REVISION HISTORY

Revision	Date	Description	Author
A	30-Aug-2026	Initial demonstration release	Technical Documentation

28. PORTFOLIO DEMONSTRATION NOTICE

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END OF DOCUMENT

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